POWERPLAY — Mechanics Reference Card

The corporate compliance handbook your characters never bothered to read. Quick lookup of every named mechanic.

Power is checked, not spent unless explicitly paid (e.g., PowerPlay!) — the Board appreciates ambition without asking it to liquidate. Full definitions are in the Manual § II.

Power Floors (Assets Only) — the club has one door

Power Floors apply to **Assets only**. **Action and Reaction cards are free to play, with no Power Floor.** Lobbyists meet a lower bar than CEOs; CEOs meet a lower bar than oligarchs.

Tier	Asset Buy Floor	Asset Use Floor
T1	0 P	0 P
T2	2 P	2 P
T3	3 P	3 P

Applies to draw / Draft pull / Private Equity of Assets of that tier (a Draft pull of T2/T3 also needs ½ printed cost in Coins). The same floor governs which Assets may fire via synergy activation (see Activation Ladder and Ability Lock).

Track your Power on the **Power Track** dial (0–9, then 10 → 100). The labelled rungs are your unlock ladder: **1 = Character Ability**, **2 = Tier 2**, **3 = Tier 3**, **4 = PowerPlay!** — one new unlock per rung.

Ability Lock — the perks-and-Power club

When a player's Power drops below an Asset's Use Floor, that Asset's Synergy is **locked** — it cannot fire even when a matching card is played. The executive suite needs a sufficiently impressive resume. **Income still flows. Op Costs still apply** — the rank-and-file keeps the lights on regardless. The Synergy unlocks automatically when Power meets / exceeds the Use Floor again.

Countering (Reactions)

Action and Reaction decks are **tier-less single piles** — there are no tier restrictions on Countering:

- **Any Reaction can Counter any Action** — or any **individual Asset Synergy fire** (each fire is a separate event with its own response window, so a 3-fire Action offers up to 3 separate Counter opportunities).
- **Reactions mitigate, not negate** — playing a Reaction reduces or compensates for the incoming effect; it does not fully cancel the Action or fire. Direct prevention is capped at 2 Coins of value; larger losses resolve and the Reaction's compensation applies instead.
- **No Reaction-to-Reaction** — a Reaction can never be played in response to another Reaction. The chain always ends at the first Reaction.
- **Response-only** — a Reaction is never played proactively on your own turn; it always answers a trigger (an Action card, a synergy fire, or an Event). Nothing is immune: every fire, effect, and Event opens a response window.
- **Open to everyone** — any player may react to any trigger, affected or not. The printed effect is the Reactor's (a prevention protects whoever they defend); the Reactor's own matching Asset fires and the Reactor aims it — it need not hit the Attacker. One Reaction per trigger: affected player first, then turn order from the Leader.

Activation Ladder (Industry Synergy)

Playing a card fires **your own Assets'** Synergy clauses by matching Industry. Cards carry Industry tags (Actions: primary + secondary; Reactions: one); only the playing player's portfolio counts.

- **Action — Base (free with card play)**: the card's base effect resolves AND **2 of your primary-Industry Assets fire** their Synergy clauses.
- **Action — Influencing Decision (pay 1 Influence, optional)**: the card's **secondary Industry is unlocked** and **1 more Asset fires** (from either Industry) — **3 fires total**. No Coin activation costs; no other levels. You may declare it only if you hold 1 Influence when you play the card.
- **Reaction**: on play, **1 matching-Industry Asset fires automatically** (no cost, no ladder).

Each Asset fires at most once per card play, gated by its Use Floor. The Asset's owner picks the target of each fire (self-target allowed unless the clause names "an opponent"). **Resolution**: fires resolve one at a time, in the order the acting player chooses; each targeted player gets a chance to React before their fire resolves. If several players want to React to the same fire, the player earliest in turn order from the Leader goes first — and the targeted player always has first right before a bystander defends them.

- **Action** fires: checked against the **Attacker's** Assets.
- **Reaction** fires: checked against the **Reactor's** Assets (may not be the Defender).

PowerPlay! — Free Action

Hold at least **4 P** (checked) and pay **2 P** → this turn you may **play up to 2 Action cards**; **one of them gets the Influencing Decision for free** (the other can still buy it for 1 Influence); draw **1 Action card + 1 Reaction card**. Once per turn. Every fire it produces can be reacted to as normal; the activation itself has nothing to react to. Spending from exactly 4 P leaves you at 2 P — below the Tier 3 floor — so plan for the lock-out.

Reroll Tokens

Each player starts with **2**. Spend one during your own income roll to reroll **one** income die (you may spend both on the same die). One-time use — spent tokens go back to the supply and are never replenished.

Attach

A card persists on a target Asset (or player) until a condition is met or its duration expires, then is discarded. **No base-game Action card attaches** — the four Infrastructure-primary Actions (Compliance Fine, Patent Violation, Grid Modernization, Public Works) are Instant. The keyword stays in the glossary for Events, Assets, and future expansion content; financial tokens (Loans, IOUs) also track as attached state.

During Organize the Desk, remove any expired Attached cards from your Assets and yourself. Financial tokens follow their own rules and are NOT cleared at Organize the Desk.

Loan (Corporate Debt) — patience with interest

Relationship: player ↔ supply (bank). No Attacker, no Defender — the bank is your counterparty. Distinct from an IOU (see below), which is player ↔ player.

- **Take a Loan** at any time you are not inside a resolution (any turn, the Lunch Break, Debt Settlement, Bankruptcy Resolution — never while an Action / fire / Reaction resolves or during Market Operation bidding; never a turn action): up to **floor(printed cost / 2)** from the supply, secured against an Asset (collateral → Asset Mortgaged).
- **Max 2 active loans / player** (checked when you take one).
- **Maintenance**: 1 C / active loan at Call-it-a-Night. **Grace round** on the round of acquisition.
- **Voluntary repayment** (at Call-it-a-Night): pay **principal + 1 C** → Asset unmortgaged.
- **Mortgaged Assets cannot be sold** (by any means) while the loan is active — repay the loan to unmortgage the Asset before selling it. (They do still earn income.)

- **Default**: attached Asset → discard; bank pays printed cost to **the player**; the player pays principal + 1 C; the player keeps the surplus (1 C / 3 C / 6 C for T1/T2/T3). Loan discharged. **No elimination from loan default.**

IOU (Player Debt) — a polite gun at your head

Relationship: player ↔ player — the Defender owes the Attacker. Distinct from a Loan (above), which is player ↔ supply. The IOU lives in the Attacker's possession until settled or traded.

When an Action effect demands a resource the Defender lacks → the Defender takes a **Coin-denominated IOU** held by the Attacker instead. The Board accepts promissory notes. The Board also remembers them.

Shortfall	IOU value (per missing unit)
1 IP	4 C (3 + 1 interest)
1 P	7 C (6 + 1 interest)
1 C	(X + 1) C

- **Cap**: 2 new IOUs / Defender / round (further triggers floor at 0).
- **Settlement**: at Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement (after voluntary loan repayment, before Thievery).
- **Order**: voluntary IOU repayment → negotiation → forced liquidation (Defender picks an unencumbered Asset; bank pays printed cost; Defender pays Attacker MIN(IOU, available C); cascades).
- **Elimination only if** an IOU is unpaid AND no unencumbered Assets remain AND no negotiated agreement is reached.
- **Tradable** in any deal (a creditor may sell an IOU to a third party). **Attacker elimination wipes their held IOUs.**

Deals — any time, two Deal Tokens per round

Voluntary two-party deals (Action / Reaction cards, Assets, Coins, IOUs — never Influence or Power) can be struck whenever you are not inside a resolution: on any turn, between the two Actions of a PowerPlay! turn, during the Lunch Break, and during Debt Settlement. Not while an Action, fire, or Reaction is resolving, and not during Market Operation bidding. **Each deal costs each party one Deal Token.** You hold 2; both come back at the Opening Bell hand refill. A Strategic Access deal (the Lobbyist) costs neither party a token.

Signing Bonus

One-time grant when you acquire an Asset from the **Market Operation draft or Private Equity**. **Does NOT apply on trades or forced/hostile transfers** (e.g., Hostile Takeover).

Tier	Signing Bonus
T1	none
T2	Gain 1 IP
T3	Gain 1 Power

Character Action — Free, Once per Round

Free Action with **no cost at all** — activating your Character Ability spends no Coins, Influence, or Power. Requirements: you must **hold at least 1 Power** (checked, not spent), and each ability may only be used **at the moment printed on the character card** — a phase, or an event such as making a deal or paying loan maintenance. **Frequency: once per round** (1 use across both of your turns). No character starts with any Power (everyone starts at 0). Abilities can be reacted to.

Resource Flow Notation

Card text follows a consistent vocabulary:

Phrase	Meaning
`gain X`	Receive from supply (no transfer between players).
`lose X`	Lose to supply (no transfer).
`pay X to [player]`	Direct transfer from one player to another.
`take X from [player]` / `steal X from [player]`	Transfer from named player to playing player.

Defaults: "Attacker gains +Y" without a source → supply. "Defender loses Y" without a destination → supply.

Counter-Verbs (single-line)

Verb	Meaning
Counter	Respond to an Action or an individual synergy fire with a Reaction; **mitigates** (reduces or compensates), does not fully negate. Any Reaction can Counter any Action.
Prevent	Block a specific effect (loss or damage).
Redirect	Send the effect to another player.
Replace	Discard 1 card of the specified type → draw 1 new card of the same type.